Business Growth Optimization for a U.S.-Based Company

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Company Overview

- **COMPANY NAME:** SUPERSTORE INC.
- **INDUSTRY:** RETAIL (PRODUCT AND OFFICE SUPPLIES)
- **LOCATION:** UNITED STATES (NATIONWIDE PRESENCE)
- **TYPE:** PRODUCT & SERVICE-BASED COMPANY
- **BUSINESS MODEL:** B2B AND B2C
- **DATA SOURCE:** INTERNAL SALES & OPERATIONS DATABASE (9,994 TRANSACTIONS)
- **REGIONS COVERED:** WEST, EAST, CENTRAL, SOUTH
- **CUSTOMER SEGMENTS:** CONSUMER, CORPORATE, HOME OFFICE
- **DISTRIBUTION CHANNELS:** ONLINE ORDERS WITH REGIONAL DELIVERY LOGISTICS
- **SHIPPING MODES:** STANDARD CLASS, SECOND CLASS, FIRST CLASS, SAME DAY

Project Goal:

THE COMPANY AIMS TO:

- MAXIMIZE REVENUE AND PROFIT ACROSS ALL REGIONS
- IMPROVE CUSTOMER SATISFACTION THROUGH TIMELY DELIVERIES
- OPTIMIZE PRODUCT INVENTORY AND REDUCE UNNECESSARY STOCK
- INCREASE REPEAT PURCHASES AND REDUCE CUSTOMER CHURN
- IDENTIFY UNDERPERFORMING AREAS AND ALLOCATE RESOURCES MORE EFFICIENTLY

Business Problems Addressed

- Unprofitable Discounts
- Low-Performing Regions & Customer Segments
- Inefficient Shipping Methods
- Overstocked or Understocked Products
- Customer Churn (Lack of Repeat Buyers)
- Sub-Category Inefficiencies

Tools & Technologies Used

- SQL (MySQL) – Data querying and transformation.
- Excel – Pivot tables and initial data exploration.
- Power BI – Interactive dashboards and visual analytics.

Key Metrics Overview

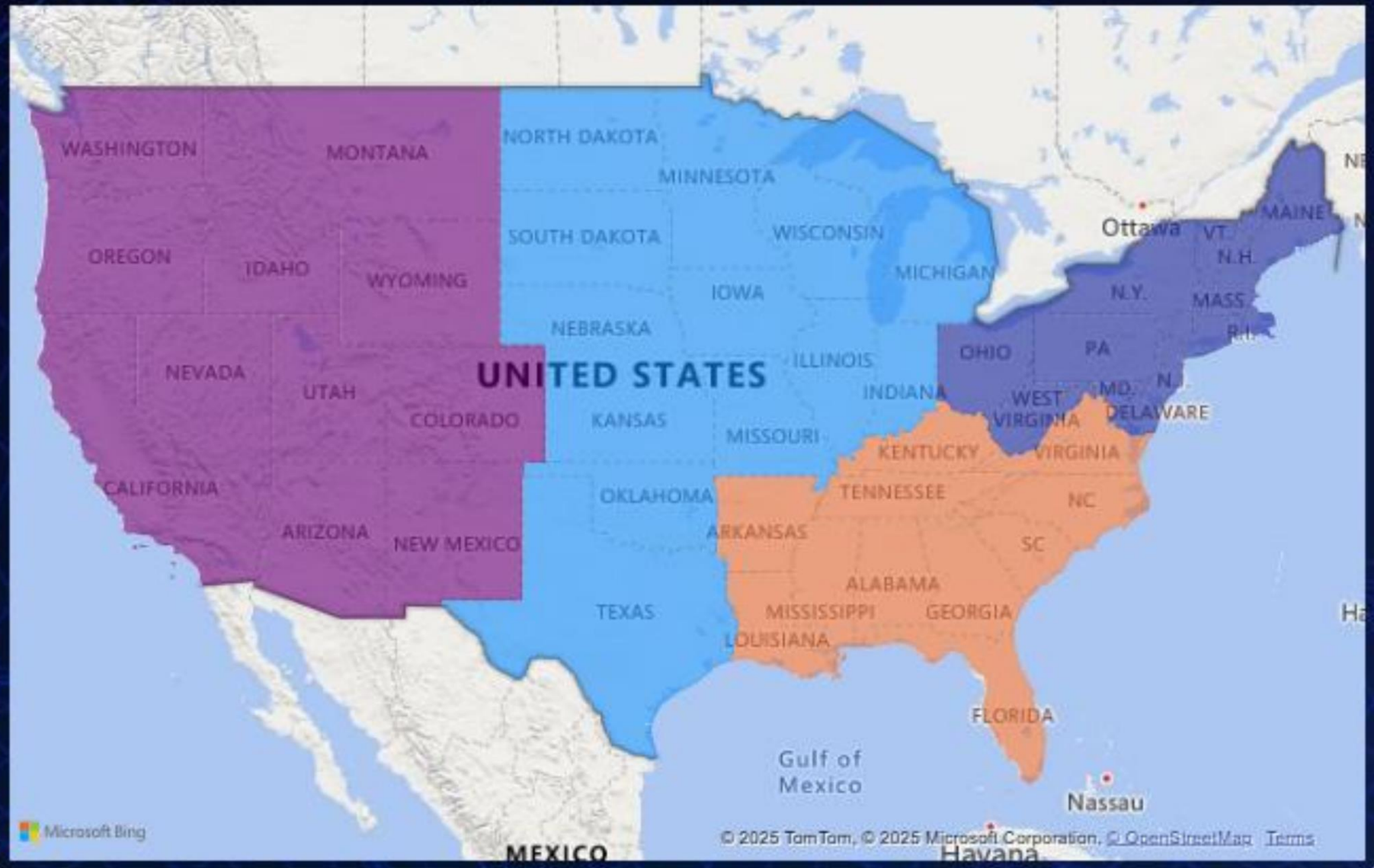
Business Problems & Insights (Each on Separate Slides)

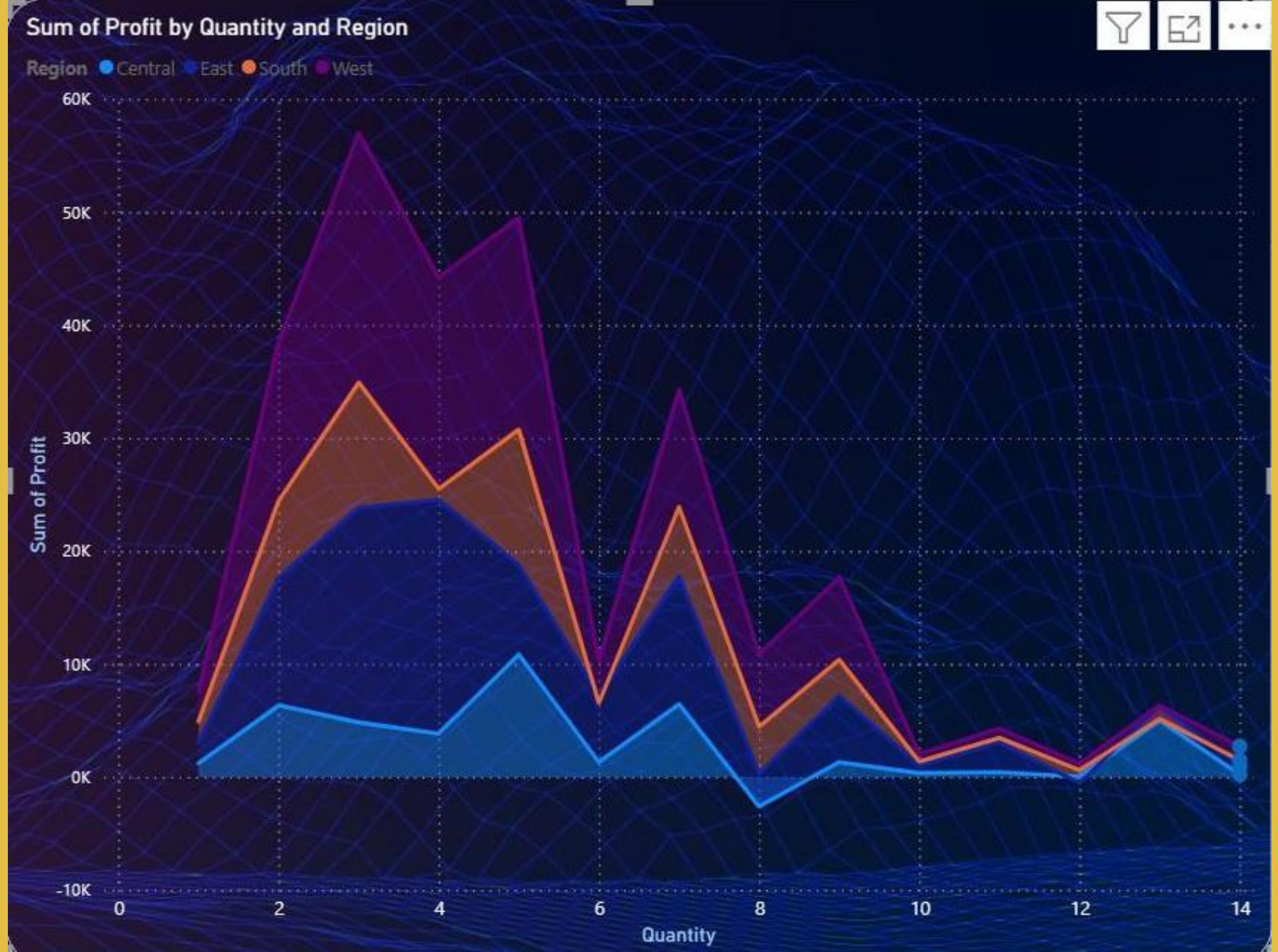
Regional Performance (Top 3)

- **South** had the lowest profit margin **(~9.1%)** and should be reviewed for cost or pricing inefficiencies.

State and Region

Region Central East South West




Sum of Profit by Quantity and Region
Region
Central
East
South
West
60K
50K
40K
30K
20K
10K
0K
-10K
Sum of Profit
0
2
4
6
8
10
12
14
Quantity

Sub-Category Profit Performance

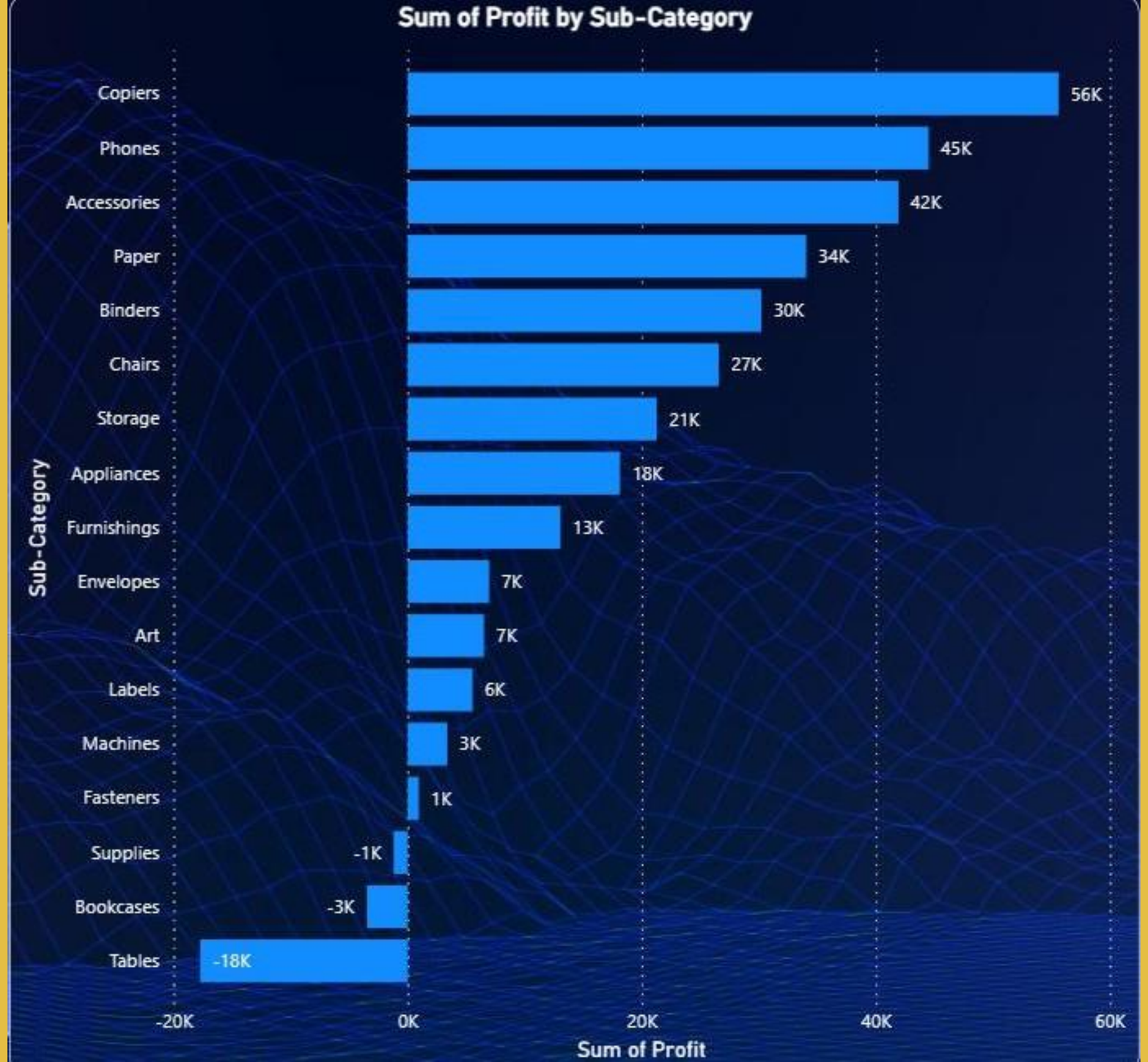
Top 3 Most Profitable:

- Copiers: $55,028.40
- Phones: $44,941.31
- Accessories: $32,312.02

Least Profitable:

- Tables: -$17,729.50
- Bookcases: -$3,440.73
- Supplies: -$2,228.15

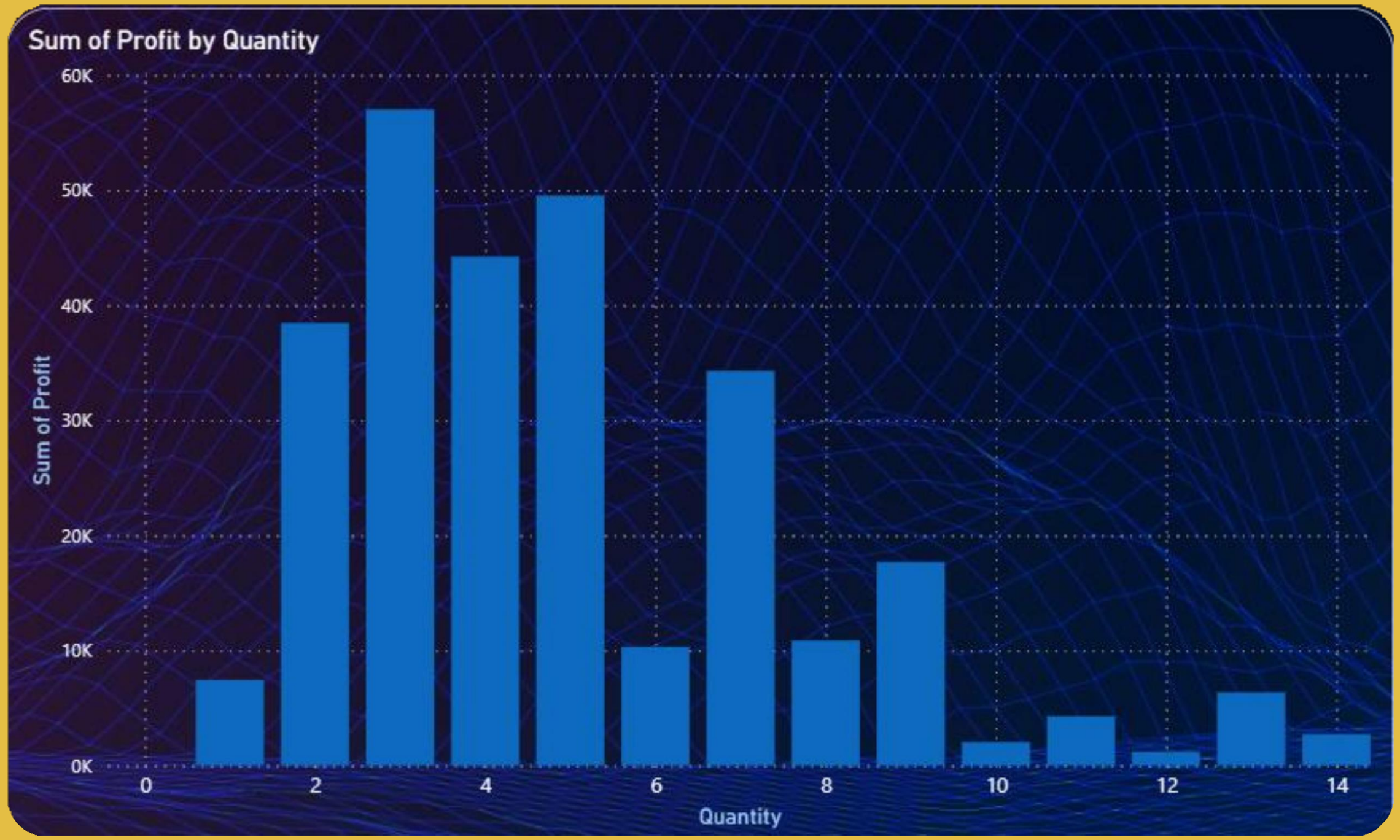
Action: Discontinue or revise pricing for low-profit items. Consider bundling or promoting high-margin sub-categories.


Sum of Profit by Sub-Category
Copiers
Phones
Accessories
Paper
Binders
Chairs
Storage
Appliances
Furnishings
Envelopes
Art
Labels
Machines
Fasteners
Supplies
Bookcases
Tables
56K
45K
42K
34K
30K
27K
21K
18K
13K
7K
7K
6K
3K
1K
-1K
-3K
-18K
Sub-Category
-20K
0K
20K
40K
60K
Sum of Profit

Discount & Profitability Insights

- **42.8%** of orders included a **discount.**
- **21.1%** of all orders resulted in **negative profit.**
- Many discounted orders came from **Tables** and **Chairs**, leading to **overall loss.**

Recommendation: Set a minimum profit threshold for discounts or apply selectively to high-margin products only.

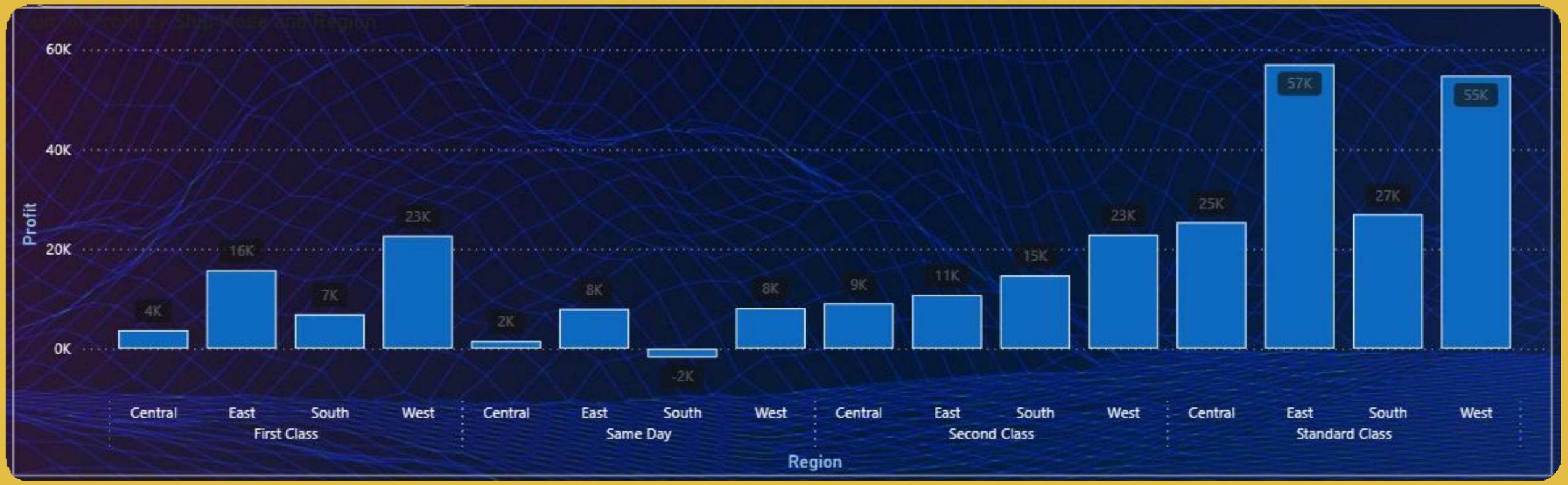

Sum of Profit by Quantity
60K
50K
40K
30K
20K
10K
0K
Sum of Profit
0
2
4
6
8
10
12
14
Quantity

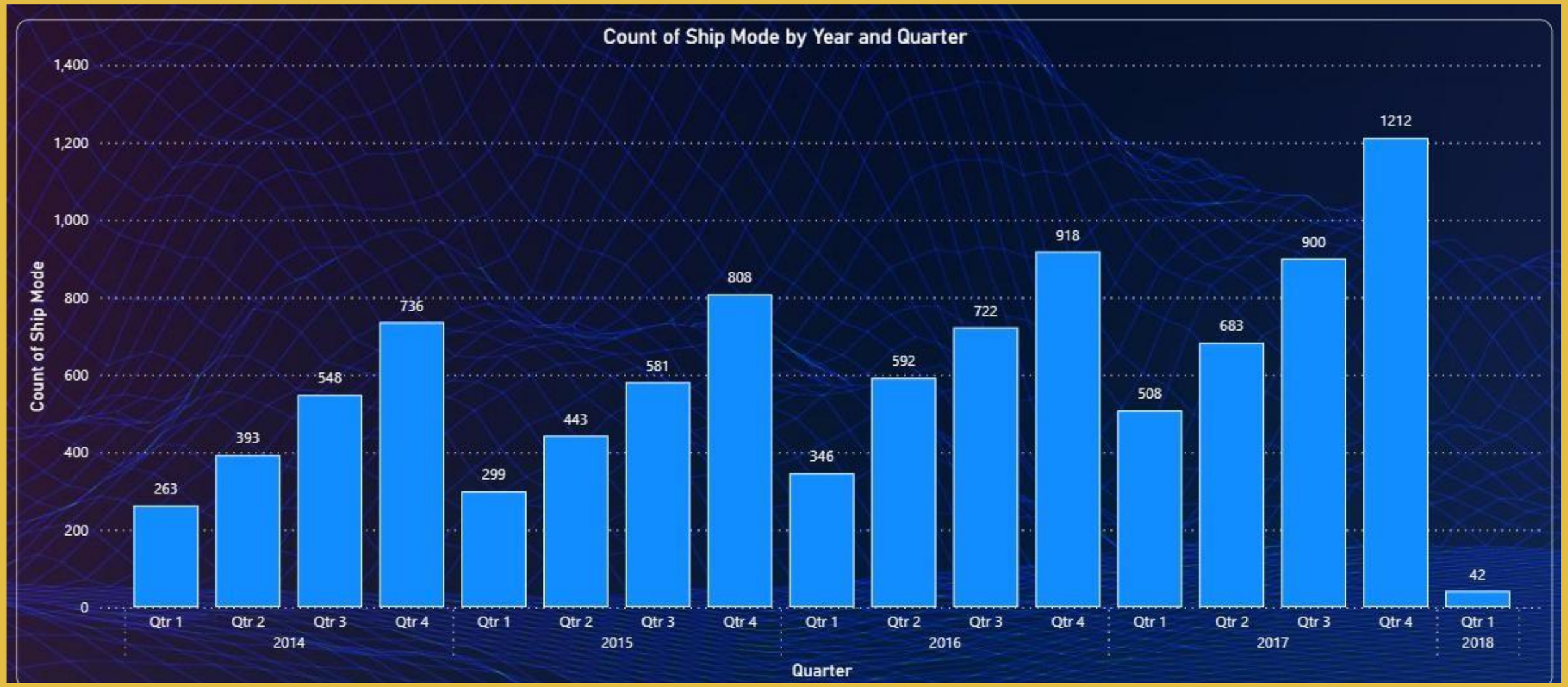
Profit by Discount
Average of Profit
100
0
-100
-200
-300
67
96
27
25
-46
-89
-112
-227
-311
-43
-96
-102
0.0
0.2
0.4
0.6
0.8
Discount

Delivery Performance

- **Average** delivery time**: 4.2 days.**
- **Same Day** and **First Class** ship modes had the **highest profitability.**
- **Delays** were common in **Standard Class,** affecting **customer satisfaction**.

Action: Reassess shipping policies and improve delivery times for critical regions.


60K
40K
20K
0K
Profit
4K
16K
7K
23K
2K
8K
-2K
8K
9K
11K
15K
23K
25K
57K
27K
55K
Central
East
South
West
First Class
Central
East
South
West
Same Day
Central
East
South
West
Second Class
Central
East
South
West
Standard Class
Region


Count of Ship Mode by Year and Quarter
Count of Ship Mode
1,400
1,200
1,000
800
600
400
200
0
263
393
548
736
299
443
581
808
346
592
722
918
508
683
900
1212
42
Qtr 1
Qtr 2
Qtr 3
Qtr 4
2014
2015
2016
2017
2018
Quarter

Customer Trends

- **Majority** of customers are **one-time buyers**
- **Top 5 customers** contributed to over **$50,000** in total sales
- **Low retention** suggests missed opportunities for **loyalty** and **upselling**

Recommendation: Start loyalty or re-engagement campaigns for high-value or inactive customers**.**

Key Business Findings

- **Deep discounts (>30%)** often lead to net losses.
- **West – Home Office** segment showed lowest profitability.
- **Standard Class shipping** caused longer delivery delays.
- **Fasteners & Supplies** sold poorly, suggesting inventory imbalance.
- **40%+ customers** made only one purchase → **risk of churn.**

Recommendations

- **Cap discounts** at levels where profit stays positive**.**
- **Focus** marketing efforts on underperforming regions/segments.
- **Optimize or switch** shipping modes with high delay times.
- **Clear inventory o**f low-performing sub-categories.
- **Launch loyalty** campaigns to improve repeat purchases.

Q&A

- Questions
- Comments
- Ideas?

Drop them below!

ThANk YOU